

Preparation of client machines

With the aim of stopping the Microsoft Defender Antivirus from blocking the exploits' transfer and execution, the following two registry keys were added in a safe boot mode. The first key sets the Antivirus dependency to a non-existent service titled RpcSs-Disabled, whereas the second key disables the WinDefend service. Such a combination prevents WinDefend from repairing its state after a reboot.

```
reg add "HKLM\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Services\WinDefend" /v  
"DependOnService" /t REG_MULTI_SZ /d "RpcSs-Disabled" /f
```

```
reg add "HKLM\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Services\WinDefend" /v "Start" /t  
REG_DWORD /d 4 /f
```

To prevent the second Windows client from blocking lateral movement, the firewall exception was added with the instruction `netsh advfirewall firewall set rule group="File and Printer Sharing" new enable=Yes`. Furthermore, Windows Defender Firewall was turned off, an Administrator account was enabled, and User Access Control was set to Never Notify on both Windows clients. Several other per-session controls were disabled on both Windows clients to allow the attack chain to succeed.

In accordance with the scenario, Google Chrome was installed on the domain members, and several passwords were added to the browser's password manager. Subsequently, a .pfx certificate was imported into the originally compromised machine. In addition, the Administrator password on the clients and the domain controller was set to Password123! in line with the default value set in the adversary .yaml configuration file. Furthermore, a file Employee list.docx was transferred to the target machines to be exfiltrated as part of the attack scenario.